UP Writing Lesson Plan

Course Details

Class: University Prep Writing **Semester:** Fall 2026	**Date:** Wed. 10/7/26	**Number of students:** 12
Teacher: Grace Smith	**Lesson title: Writing Skill: Development**	

Background: We are in Week 5. We have been talking about personal statements, specifically their assignment to write either a mock or real college admissions essay. I have introduced what admission essays are, how to structure them, and we've looked at examples. This weekend, they will turn in their first draft for the admission essay. Today's lesson will focus on the skill of developing their ideas in their writing because on their last essays, many students did not receive full points on idea development. I want them to improve this area on this writing assignment. These students are almost all willing to participate, and very quick to make comments during class.

Lesson Objectives

Terminal (overall):

1. Students will be able to identify developed ideas and do it themselves.

Enabling (specific to each task):

1. Students can identify well-developed and poorly developed paragraphs, and explain why a paragraph lacks development.
2. Students can generate their own well-developed paragraph for their own admission essay through multiple details about a personal experience or story.

Materials

1. Chromebook blue bucket 1
2. Powerpoint
3. Projector
4. Canvas access (for both student and teacher)
5. Online document access (google docs or microsoft)
6. Wheel of Names

Sequencing of Lesson

Time	Title	Description/Action
12:00-12:02	Opening Exercises and Attendance	Take attendance. A student is assigned for Opening Exercises today. She will share either a quote or scripture or pray for the class.
12:02-12:04	Overview of the Lesson and Objectives	Explain Today's Agenda: - Warm up: Quick Write #13 - Skill Development Practice: We do - Skill Development Implementation: You do Explain the Lesson objectives and Course Outcomes: - See lesson objectives above
30 seconds	*Transition*	*Invite students to open their computers to their document containing their Quick Write practices. Give them time to get it open until everyone's ready.*
12:05-12:15	Warm-up: Quick Write	Quick Write #13: - Read the Prompt on slide: "Compare and contrast how technology both brings people closer together and makes them feel more isolated?" They have 10 minutes and should write the whole time. - Monitor students as they write - If students finish writing before 10 minutes is up, expand the prompt by asking: "Think about technology in your own personal life. Answer the question to that thought. Then think about it nationally (in the US). Then globally. How does tech use differ as the population increases?" Help them think deeper about the prompt.
30 second	*Transition*	*Once the timer ends for the quick write, tell them to*

		wrap up their thoughts, save the document, and close their computers.
12:16-12:22	Instruction: Skill: Development	Slide: Which one is better? - A. Technology is important for students. - B. Technology helps students succeed by providing instant access to course materials, collaborative tools, and research databases. - Ask: - Which sentence gives you a clearer picture? Why? - What information is missing from Sentence A? - Discuss as a class. Cold call on students if no one raises hands; they are comfortable with this. Slide: Background: Who was Helen Keller? - Before showing blurb about her, ask students what they already know. - Allow for them to share. - Show the blurb. Explain who she is. Don't answer any more questions. We will read 2 paragraphs about her. See if their further questions will be answered then.
12:23-12:30	Practice	Slide: Example Paragraph 1 *(this is the poor example)* - Cold call a student to read this paragraph. - Ask: "What questions do you still have about her after you read this paragraph?" - Students will share their questions with a partner. - Then each group/pair will share with the whole class their question(s). Slide: Example Paragraph 2 *(this is the better*

		developed example) - Ask the last student who read to choose another student to read this next paragraph. - Ask: “What answers do you now have about her after you read this paragraph?” - Students will share their responses with a partner. - Then each group/pair will share with the whole class their responses.
12:31-12:38	Focused Discussion	Slide: Weak vs. Strong Development - Show the blank table first. - Give students 1 minute to think about what is weak vs. strong development. - Randomly call on students to share (wheel of names) and you type their responses on the slide. - Show the teacher filled table in case students missed any points. Slide: Notice - Explain that these make your writing more developed: - Dates - Locations - Explanations - Reasons - examples
12:39-12:44	Model	Slide: Develop your own paragraph - Show students questions they should ask themselves when drafting and revising their writing - Why? - How? - Like what?

		- When? - Where? - Who? - What does that mean? Slide: My example Topic sentence: Learning English can improve career opportunities. - Conduct a think-a-loud - Show your answers to the questions in red - Show students my final example paragraph and how I incorporated the questions
12:45-1:00	Student Practice/Implementation	Slide: Your turn! Come up with answers to the questions to write a supporting paragraph for your admission essay. - Remind them again of the admission essay requirements and prompts they can choose to answer. - Show it on Canvas on the screen so they can follow along - Computers: Give them time to write a supporting paragraph for their own admission essay. - Walk around and monitor. Help students as needed.
30 seconds	*Transition*	*Once it's 1:00, bring students' attention back to the front/to me to conduct the closure activity. It can be a verbal call for attention or switch the lights on and off.*
1:01-1:05	Closure	Slide: Closure: One-Minute teacher! - Students must pretend that they are talking to a classmate who was absent today and share what we learned/what they missed. - Explain that they all have a chance of being

		chosen (wheel of names will randomly pick someone), so they all need to prepare an answer in their minds - Give them about a minute to think of their response - The wheel of names chooses someone and they must share their thoughts
30 seconds	*Transition*	*Show the homework slide to remind them what's due.* *Dismiss them from class.*

Contingency Plan

Slide: Remaining time

Start writing the rest (first draft) of your Admission Essay! Make sure you have:

- Hook
- Thesis
- Supporting Details
- Conclusion

Make sure you stay under the 1500 character limit.

Homework

Learning Experiences:

- LE: Admission Essay - Draft 1 due Thursday night
- LE: Typing Practice Week 5 due Friday night

Proficiency Assignment: NA

Teacher Reflections

Questions:

- What did I miss that I need to cover next time?
- Did I help students accomplish the learning objectives?